

Intern onboarding

USC circulated the description on 23 September and nine students applied within about twenty-six hours. This is what happens between an application and a first published interview.

Two things are not settled and are marked [FOR YOU] below: how many interns we take, and who supervises them day to day. Everything else here is ready.

Applicant names, emails and CVs do not go in this repository. It is public. Keep them in the mailbox and, if a tracker is needed, alongside Grace's caregiver tracker in Drive.

The shape of it

Stage	What happens	Who
Applied	Acknowledge within a day, promise a date	Emmanuel
Screened	20 minute call, questions below	[FOR YOU: who]
Offered	Offer email, start date, first assignment	
Week 1	Find and verify 5 clinicians. No contact with anyone yet	
Week 2	First invitations sent, using our template	
Week 3	First interview recorded	
Week 4	First interview published, with their byline	

The screening call

Twenty minutes, and it is a conversation rather than an interview. The purpose is to find out whether they will be comfortable writing to a consultant neurologist who has never heard of us, because that is the part that stops people.

1. What drew you to this rather than a clinical placement?
2. Tell me about a time you had to contact someone senior you did not know. What did you write?
3. You email twelve clinicians and one replies. How does that week feel?
4. A clinician says something on camera that would embarrass a patient if it were published. What do you do?
5. What would you want to ask a geriatrician, if you had thirty minutes?
6. How many hours a week can you genuinely give, in your worst week rather than your best?
7. Anything about this that worries you?

Question four matters most. The answer to look for is that they would stop, flag it, and not publish it. There is no correct wording.

Tell them plainly: the interviews cover diagnosis, decline and end of life care. If dementia is in their own family, that is worth thinking about. Two of the applicants have said it already.

Week one, before they contact anybody

The first assignment is research, not outreach. They find and verify five dementia clinicians in one assigned city and submit them in the format below.

This is deliberate. It teaches the standard before they represent us to anyone, and it is the same method that has produced forty-seven verified university addresses with one bounce.

The rule: **a real address published on a real page, and that page's URL recorded.** Not a guess at a pattern, not a search result summary, not an address from a research paper. If the address cannot be read on the page, the clinician does not go on the list.

Name:
Specialty: neurologist, geriatrician, geriatric psychiatrist,
 memory clinic staff, social worker, ombudsman
City:
Where they work:
Email:
Source URL: the page the address is published on
NPI number: if they are in the federal registry
Why them: one line

Five verified takes most people two to three hours. Expect four attempts per address. The method is in `docs/outreach-research.md`.

The weekly rhythm

- **Monday:** assignment for the week, and anything blocked from last week.
- **During the week:** invitations sent, replies handled, interviews recorded.
- **Friday:** what went out, what came back, what was recorded, what is stuck.

One standing rule, from `templates.ts` and the content gate: **we never ask a clinician to endorse or recommend us, and the published page never suggests they do.** If a clinician offers praise unprompted, thank them and leave it out. The value of these interviews is that they are expertise rather than advertising, and one testimonial-shaped quote undermines every other page on the site.

Nothing is published without a signed release. See `consent-release.md`. The interview questions are in `interview-questions.md`.

What we owe them

A reference at the end. Their name on every interview they record. An answer within a day when they are stuck. And honesty about what this is: a young organisation, an unpaid placement, and work that is genuinely useful.

Reply templates

Offer

Dear [Name],

I would like to offer you a place. [CEO: number] of you applied and I am glad to say yes to yours.

The practical shape: unpaid, remote, about 10 hours a week, starting [date]. Your first week is research rather than outreach, so you learn the standard before you write to anybody. Your day to day contact is [CEO: name].

If your programme can award credit for this, tell me what it needs and we will support it. If your programme requires a formal agreement, send it over and we will complete our side.

Can you make a short call on [date] to start?

Not this round

Dear [Name],

Thank you for applying, and I am sorry: we had more applications than places this term.

This is not a comment on your application. [CEO: number] places and nine strong candidates in a day made it a hard choice.

If you would like me to keep your details for the next round, say so and I will. And if it would help, I am happy to tell you what stood out in your application.

Say what stood out if they ask. A student who has been rejected and given nothing learns nothing.